Compressing dense similarity for dataset splitting with global and local control

Author information pending

Abstract

An evaluation split specifies which relationships a model must generalize beyond. Controlling total similarity between folds involves a dense pairwise objective whose explicit storage grows quadratically. We present a capacity-controlled splitting framework that represents this objective through low-rank coordinates and compact fold sums. Across six molecular datasets, the largest observed rank-256 cut error is 0.0070 of the ordinary kernel's off-diagonal similarity mass. Controls with identical groups and fold counts show that factor-space optimization adds to the separation obtained from grouping alone. On 32 CPU cores, the plain setting partitions two million fingerprints in a median 4.1 minutes with a 1% capacity corridor. Comparisons with DataSAIL and an ordinary graph partitioner reveal distinct quality–cost choices: controlling distributed overlap and excluding close analogues produce different partitions. Kernel powers and capped groups adjust this trade-off, with additional approximation and computational costs. Independent cohorts in a synthetic family model show why the intended transfer task matters: random and family-separated splits support different model-selection decisions. A metadata-only ODAC25 case constructs a count-matched composition holdout covering 37.7 million configurations through 2,050 group representatives. The framework makes specified similarity-aware evaluation boundaries computationally accessible while keeping approximation, capacity constraints and task validity explicit.

Keywords: dataset splitting; similarity; Nyström approximation; model evaluation; molecular machine learning.

1 Introduction

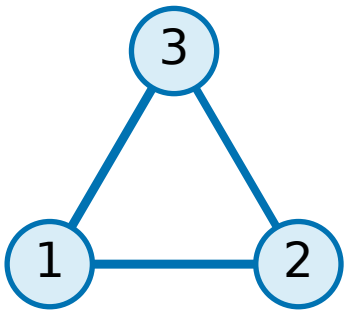
An evaluation split defines the generalization task a model must solve. Predicting another member of a known chemical series differs from predicting a new series. Random, scaffold, cluster and temporal splits impose different boundaries between these tasks and can change apparent model performance [Wu et al., 2018, Yang et al., 2019]. Lo-Hi makes the distinction between lead optimization and novel-hit identification explicit [Steshin, 2023]. Temporal studies and SIMPD show why the appropriate boundary depends on the project scenario [Sheridan, 2013, Landrum et al., 2023]. An evaluation procedure therefore needs both a computational way to construct the boundary and a scientific reason to use it.

Similarity provides a direct design objective: reduce the similarity crossing folds while controlling their sizes. The objective includes every entity pair, so storing its matrix requires quadratic memory. DataSAIL addresses the problem through clustering and integer programming [Joeres et al., 2025, 2026]. A nearest-neighbour graph represents selected pairwise relationships. These approaches raise a useful question: can the dense overlap itself be optimized approximately without storing the dense matrix?

Low rank is useful here because many pairwise similarities can share a smaller set of coordinates. Each entity receives a short vector whose dot product approximates its similarity to another entity. Cross-fold overlap can then be evaluated from the sum of vectors in each fold. The solver compares assignments using compact sums while keeping fold capacities explicit (Figure 1). This benefit depends on whether the chosen kernel is compressible at an affordable rank. Nyström approximation and its connections to kernel clustering are established [Williams and Seeger, 2000, Dhillon et al., 2004, Gittens and Mahoney, 2016, Wang et al., 2019, Chitta et al., 2011]. Our contribution is a constrained splitting framework, accuracy and feasibility diagnostics, and evidence about the evaluation boundaries it can construct.

Making the dense objective affordable also clarifies a limit of its meaning. A sum over many pairs can assign little importance to a few close analogues crossing a split. Those analogues may strongly affect prediction. We therefore distinguish global overlap from each test entity's closest training neighbour. Kernel powers emphasize strong similarities, while capped groups encourage nearby entities to remain together. These choices change the optimization problem and its cost. They provide control over an evaluation boundary; their usefulness must be assessed against the intended transfer task.

The experiments address four questions: whether compression preserves the objective and optimization adds to grouping, how the resulting quality and cost compare with established alternatives, how capacity tolerance affects scaling, and when the boundary gives a useful evaluation decision. The primary experiments use one pinned implementation. Earlier-release molecular, materials and assay studies are retained as explicitly identified supporting evidence in the Supplementary Information. A separately versioned ODAC25 application tests metadata-only composition holdouts at the original configuration counts (Section 3.5).



Coarsen
Weighted supernodes
and inter-group edges



Sparsify

Select nearby pairs



Compress
Shared coordinates
approximate all pairs

Fold sum $p(c) = \Sigma\ B(i)$ for i in fold c
Cut = ½ [$\|\Sigma\ p(c)\|^2 - \Sigma\ \|p(c)\|^2$]

Figure 1: Representing similarity for split construction. Coarsening replaces entities with weighted supernodes and retains inter-group connections. Sparsification selects individual pairwise edges. Low-rank compression represents similarities through shared coordinates, enabling the fold-sum identity in Equation 2. The illustrations describe representations, not interchangeable feasible sets or identical algorithms.

2 Low-rank similarity splitting

2.1 Objective and compressed representation

Let $S \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$ be a symmetric, nonnegative, positive-semidefinite similarity kernel, and let z_i denote entity i's fold. Define the unordered cross-fold cut and its normalized overlap as

$$\mathcal{C}_S(z) = \sum_{i<j} S_{ij} \mathbf{1}[z_i \neq z_j], \qquad L_S(z) = \frac{\mathcal{C}_S(z)}{\sum_{i<j} S_{ij}}. \tag{1}$$

The denominator is independent of the partition; the diagonal never contributes. We report the ratio only when its denominator is positive. Nonnegative similarity is essential to this interpretation. Positive semidefiniteness alone does not make a signed cosine kernel an overlap measure.

We construct a Nyström factor from r landmarks. If C contains entity–landmark similarities and $W = U\Lambda U^\top$ is the landmark kernel, retaining its numerically positive eigenvalues gives $B = CU_+\Lambda_+^{-1/2}$ and $\widetilde{S} = BB^\top$. For fold sums $p_c = \sum_{i:z_i=c} B_i$, the approximate cut is exactly

$$\mathcal{C}_{\widetilde{S}}(z) = \frac{1}{2}\left(\left\|\sum_c p_c\right\|^2 - \sum_c \|p_c\|^2\right). \tag{2}$$

Factor storage and fold-sum construction require $O(nr)$ space and work, respectively. This identity makes repeated objective evaluation practical without constructing $\widetilde{S}$.

At equal fixed fold sizes, minimizing this cut agrees with kernel k-means. Unequal capacities give a different weighting of within-fold similarity, so ordinary kernel k-means guarantees do not transfer directly. We distinguish the approximation of S, the quality of the heuristic optimizer, and the scientific meaning of the selected split. The supplement derives the relevant identities and conditional error bound.

2.2 Capacities, optimization and accuracy

Largest-remainder rounding converts requested proportions into integer targets summing to n. Zero tolerance enforces those targets exactly; positive tolerance permits a declared two-sided corridor. Seeded restarts alternate fold-sum calculation with capacity-constrained assignment proposals, accepting proposals that do not increase the factor objective. A bounded shortlist is refined before the final candidate is selected. Legal single moves operate within a corridor; swaps preserve exact counts [Fiduccia and Mattheyses, 1982, Kernighan and Lin, 1970]. The standard setting uses four restarts, at most 25 assignment iterations and two refined candidates. The optimizer remains heuristic.

Rank can be fixed or selected using a bounded accuracy budget. The optional joint policy grows pair sampling when uncertainty prevents a decision and grows rank when the estimated error is established as too large or the probe budget is exhausted. It accounts for all checks over a declared rank–sample grid and uses a separate final audit. The cut criterion concerns the returned partition, normalized by the kernel's total absolute off-diagonal mass. Establishing this tolerance does not certify a uniform approximation over all partitions or a near-optimal partition. Budget failure is reported explicitly.

2.3 Controlling strong local relationships

For integer $p \geq 1$, we can factorize the elementwise power $S^{\circ p}$. The Schur product theorem preserves positive semidefiniteness. Powering reduces weak similarities relative to strong ones: $0.1^3 = 0.001$, whereas $0.7^3 = 0.343$. If $N_\tau(z)$ counts crossing pairs with similarity at least $\tau > 0$, then $\mathcal{C}_{S^{\circ p}}(z) \geq \tau^p N_\tau(z)$. The powered cut consequently provides a soft penalty on strong crossing pairs. It is distinct from the mean nearest-neighbour evaluation score, and its approximation requirements must be checked separately.

Grouping restricts which assignments are permitted. We process top-32-neighbour edges above a threshold in decreasing similarity, merging components subject to a size cap. A group's factor is the sum of its members' rows; its weight is their count. Group contraction therefore preserves the factor objective exactly. The combined molecular setting uses $p = 3$, threshold 0.4, and a cap of half the smallest target fold, with component growth frozen after a cap-blocked merge.

The capacity contract determines what happens when whole groups cannot be packed. The default count-first policy may dissolve groups and reports that relaxation. The strict policy preserves every group or reports infeasibility or an unresolved feasibility check. Neither capped grouping nor a powered objective guarantees that every pair above the threshold stays within one fold. All reported quality scores use the original ordinary kernel.

2.4 Computational scope

The factor removes quadratic matrix storage, not every source of quadratic work. Input features still require $O(nd)$ space and can dominate process memory. Factor construction, assignment sorting and the number of accepted refinement moves determine runtime. Exact neighbour construction adds quadratic pairwise arithmetic even when temporary memory is blocked. Plain and combined settings therefore have separate measured scaling ranges, and exact-count refinement can cost substantially more than a relaxed corridor. Timing and memory scopes accompany the measurements.

3 Results

3.1 Compression preserves the ordinary cut, and optimization adds to grouping

The first question concerns the objective represented by the factor. Across six full molecular datasets, three seeds and five partitions per factor, the largest observed rank-256 error is 0.0070 of the ordinary kernel's off-diagonal mass. The corresponding error for the cubed kernel is 0.1367. At rank 512 these values are 0.0027 and 0.0936, respectively (Figure 2). Ordinary-kernel fidelity consequently cannot be transferred to the powered objective. A coarse powered factor can still produce useful local separation, but that behavior must be measured on the returned partition rather than inferred from ordinary-kernel accuracy.

Grouping alone is an incomplete explanation for the method's separation. With the entities, groups and exact fold counts fixed, factor-space optimization improves both global overlap and mean nearest-training similarity on all six datasets, relative to a seeded feasible

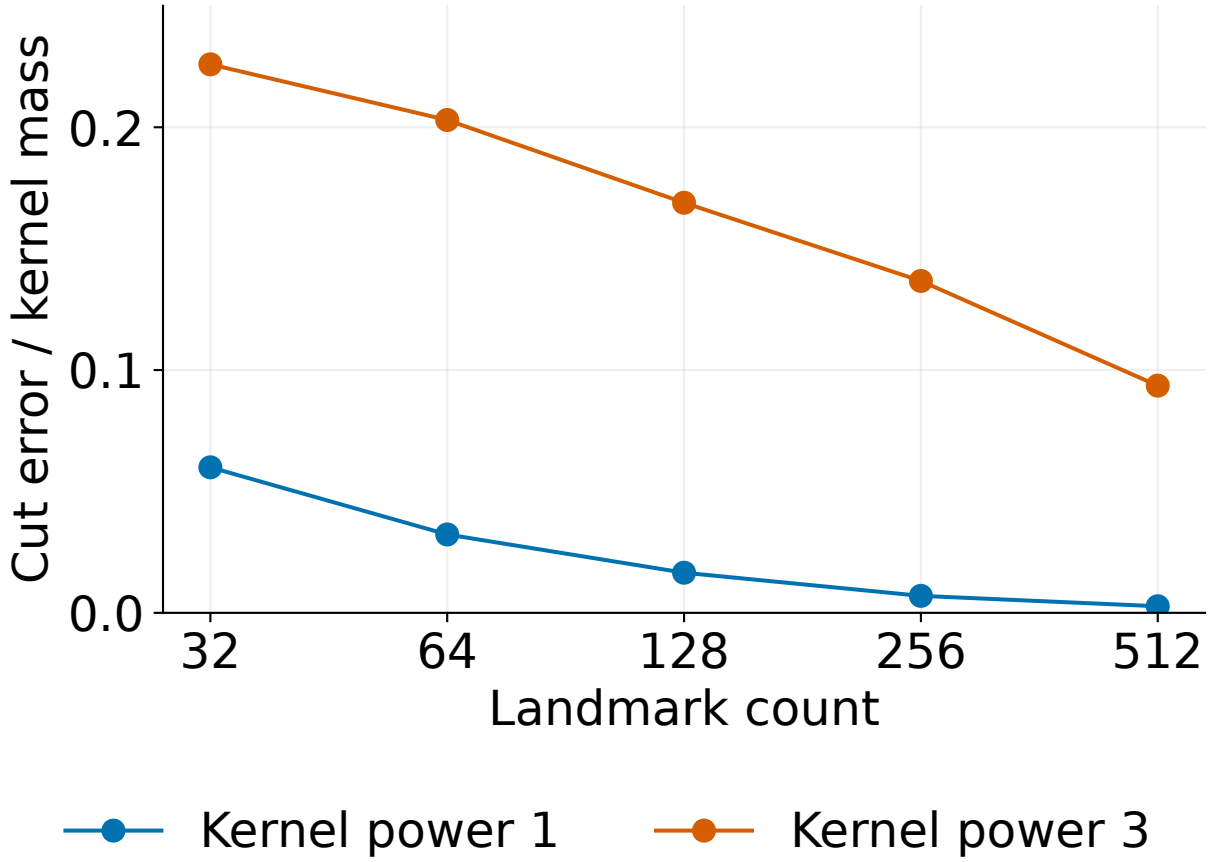


Figure 2: Current-code cut fidelity. Each point is the largest absolute factor-versus-exact cut difference divided by the corresponding kernel's off-diagonal mass, over six full datasets, three factor seeds and five partitions. Each set contains the returned partition and four count-preserving perturbations. The ordinary and cubed kernels have different denominators. These are observed cut errors, not uniform approximation guarantees.

assignment (Table 1). Every group is preserved in these controls. The experiment isolates an improvement available after grouping has already been chosen; it does not attribute every advantage of the combined pipeline to compression.

Assignment	Global overlap / random	Mean nearest similarity
Feasible groups	0.959	0.387
Groups + ordinary factor	0.791	0.306
Groups + cubed factor	0.745	0.292

Table 1: Optimization beyond grouping. Every comparison retains the same entities, constructed groups and exact 80/10/10 counts. Values average six dataset means after averaging three seeds. The factor optimizer starts from the feasible control and preserves every group. Both optimized settings improve both measures on all six datasets. Lower values indicate less overlap.

Exact references distinguish approximation from optimization more directly. On twenty 12-entity instances, we enumerate 2,970 admissible ungrouped assignments and thirty assignments with paired entities as indivisible groups. Even with all twelve landmarks, the heuristic has nonzero optimization gaps on some ungrouped instances: the largest gaps are 0.0132 and 0.0408 of kernel mass for the ordinary and cubed kernels. The grouped full-landmark cases reach their enumerated optima in this small suite. Increasing rank can therefore remove approximation error while leaving a separate optimization error. The complete decomposition and accuracy–cost controls appear in the supplement.

3.2 Dense overlap and analogue exposure give different quality–cost choices

The ordinary factor directly targets distributed overlap. Its mean global score is 0.625, compared with 0.791 for the top-32 graph, after averaging seeds within each dataset. The combined setting reduces nearest-training exposure relative to the plain setting, while the top-32 graph achieves lower mean exposure than the combined setting (0.254 versus 0.282). Changing graph degree also changes the available trade-off (Figure 3). These outcomes support choosing a representation and objective for a specified boundary rather than expecting one method ordering for every separation criterion.

DataSAIL provides the closer dense-objective comparison and reveals the importance of admissible partitions. Sixteen of its twenty-four prespecified configurations return assignments; eight report infeasibility under their cluster and capacity settings. At exactly matched native counts, entity-level low rank has mean global score 0.577, versus 0.666 for DataSAIL. Requiring low rank to preserve the groups passed to DataSAIL's solver changes its mean to 0.668, eliminating that average quality advantage. These summaries weight the four datasets equally after averaging their configurations.

Matching counts alone thus leaves a material difference in constraints. Matching groups also leaves a distinction between linked cluster similarities and sums over entity-level similarities, as well as different optimizers. The comparison does not establish that compression solves an identical optimization problem better. It establishes an economical way to construct entity-level dense-overlap splits, with the consequences of additional indivisibility constraints made visible. The supplement reports all native outcomes, timings, group-preserving controls and memory profiles.

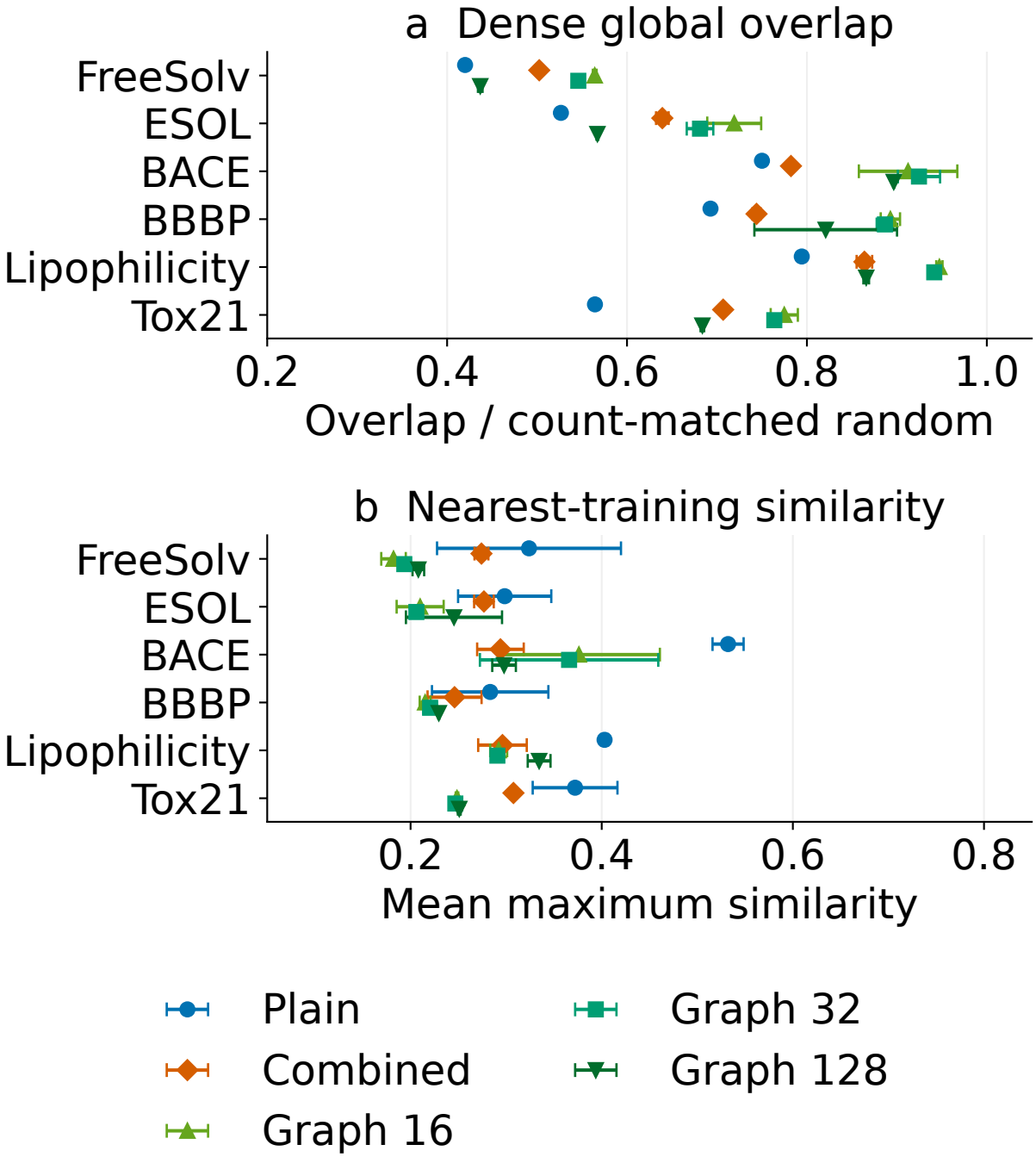


Figure 3: Global and local quality for six full molecular datasets. The primary global score is normalized by the analytic random expectation at the actual counts; the local score is mean test-to-training maximum similarity. Points average three split seeds and bars show their standard deviations. All methods retain the same input entities and use a 1% count corridor. Graph labels identify ordinary pairwise degrees; graph construction and any count repair are included in its runtime. All scores use the original ordinary Tanimoto kernel. Lower values indicate less overlap.

3.3 Exact capacities have a measurable computational cost

At 100,000 ChEMBL fingerprints on two CPU cores, the median plain split-call time is 567.2 seconds with exact counts and 40.1 seconds with a 1% corridor. The inputs, rank and restart settings are otherwise matched. The difference reflects the cost of feasible refinement, including the use of swaps at exact capacities (Figure 4). Linear factor storage therefore does not imply the same runtime at different capacity tolerances.

On lambda13, the current plain implementation partitions two million fingerprints in a median 243.9 seconds using 32 CPU cores, with peak process RSS of 58.8 GiB. All three cases retain all entities and satisfy the declared 1% corridor. This is a separate hardware configuration from the paired two-core comparison; the difference is not interpreted as an algorithmic speedup.

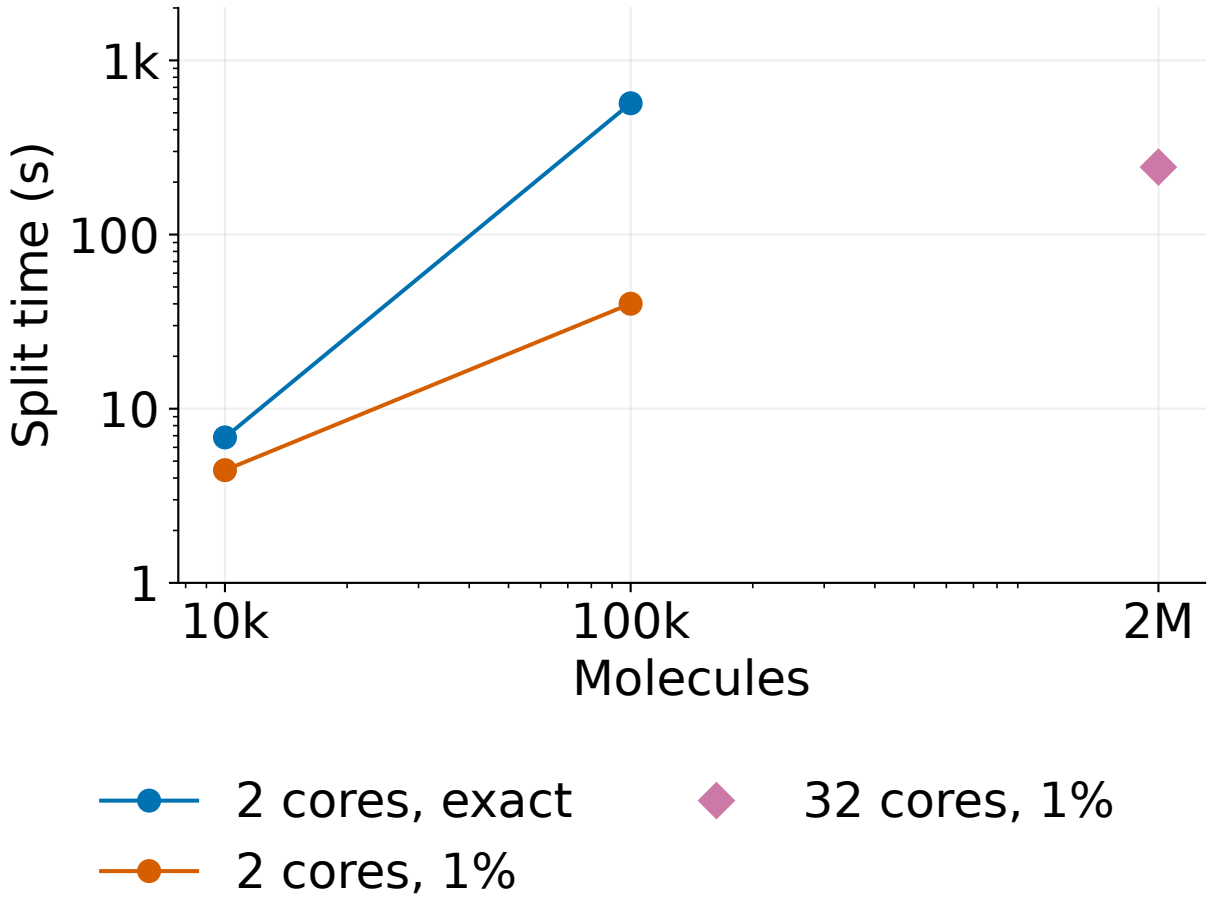


Figure 4: Current-code plain split-call time on nested ChEMBL samples, using rank 256, four restarts and two refined candidates. Two-core cases run on lambda2; the separate 32-core point runs on lambda13. Points are medians of completed cases. Warm-up, feature loading and independent auditing are outside the split clock. The full case inventory, including end-to-end budget failures and the distinct combined-setting range, appears in the supplement. An end-to-end failure is not assigned a split-call runtime.

The large-data protocol checks quality as well as computational cost. For every completed 100,000- and two-million-entity plain case, the independently sampled returned-cut error interval has an upper endpoint below 0.008 of ordinary kernel mass. Uniformly sampled test queries are also compared with every training entity, rather than a subsampled training reference. At two million entities, mean nearest-training similarity is 0.618 across the three sets of sampled queries, showing that low global overlap does not remove close-analogue exposure. Sample sizes and conservative query-sampling intervals accompany the results. The earlier v0.1 H100 measurements remain archival evidence and are not used as timings of the current implementation.

3.4 Split usefulness depends on the transfer task

Independent cohorts give a direct test of what an evaluation boundary predicts. In the synthetic family model, random splitting identifies the better model for known-family interpolation in all twenty generated instances, but identifies the better model for new-family transfer in none. The combined split shows the reverse pattern: agreement in all twenty new-family instances and none of the interpolation instances. Plain splitting lies between these outcomes (Figure 5).

The direction of error is as relevant as the ranking. Random evaluation is optimistic about the family-sensitive model on the new-family cohort, whereas the combined split is pessimistic about that model's interpolation performance. Stronger separation is useful when it matches the intended transfer boundary. Its lower held-out score alone does not make it a more realistic test.

An earlier-release assay study illustrates a related risk in real molecular data. Across ten prespecified external assays, the combined setting gives mean random-forest ROC-AUC 0.522. A label-balance sensitivity intervention at unchanged counts raises this to 0.757. The intervention also changes structural composition and may break groups, so it cannot isolate a causal contribution of label proportions. These archival results demonstrate why target composition and absolute predictive scores should accompany similarity measures. They supply no observed future outcomes against which to validate a deployment claim.

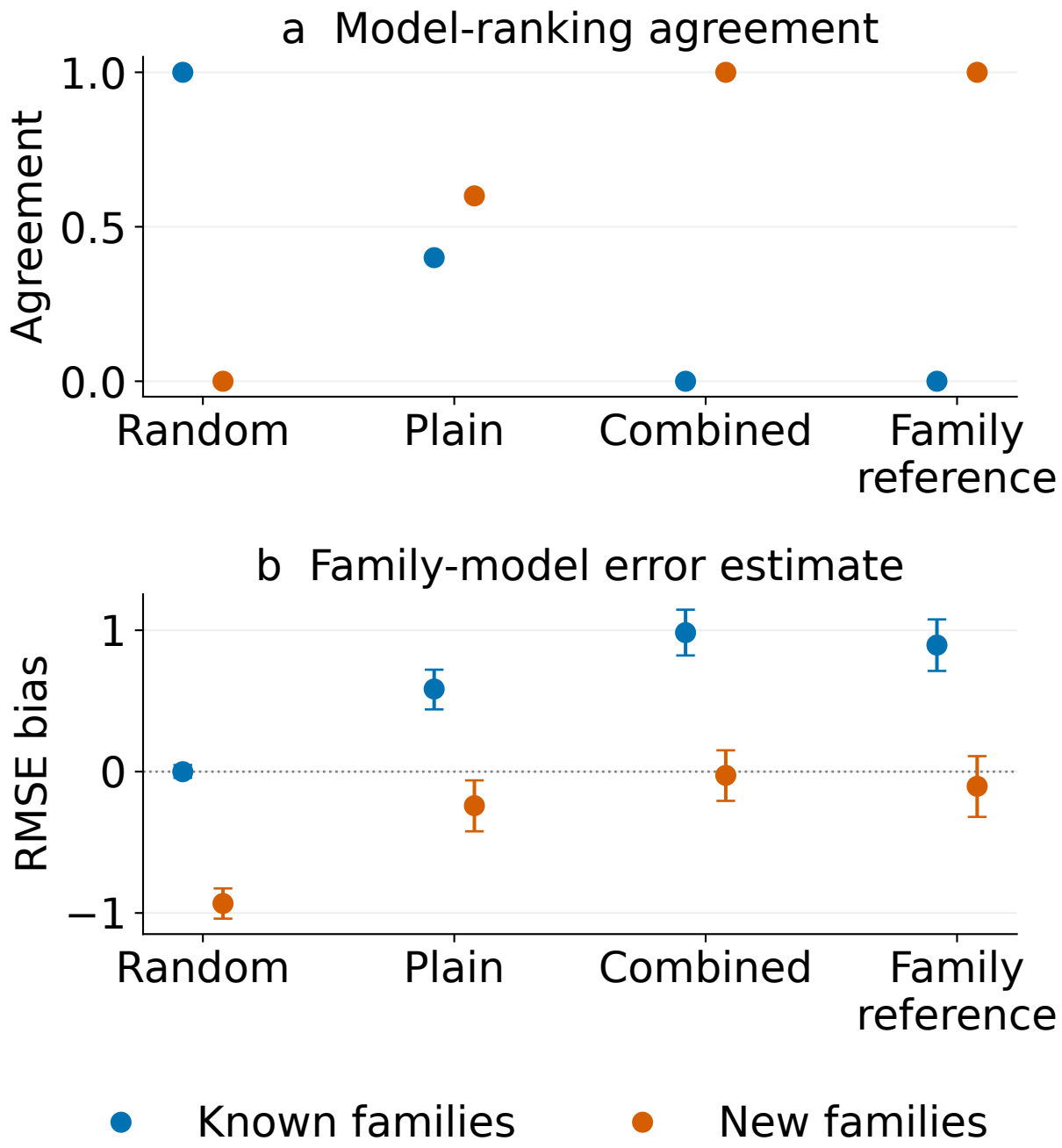


Figure 5: Evaluation boundaries for two transfer tasks in twenty synthetic instances. (a) Agreement of held-out and independent-cohort model rankings. (b) RMSE bias for the family-sensitive model; negative values are optimistic. Bars are descriptive 95% bootstrap intervals over instances. Known-family cohorts condition on families present in training. The family reference uses generator identities, and invariant ridge receives the stable features. This mechanism test supplies no prospective validation.

3.5 A metadata-only composition holdout for ODAC25

The atomistic ODAC25 release provides a separate application of constrained split design [Sriram et al., 2026]. Reading only names, formulas and multiplicities from pinned ColabFit Parquet snapshots transfers 63.4 MB of production payload. The retained 37,456,852 rows represent 37,711,674 configurations after restoring multiplicities, exactly reconciling the published filtered training and validation counts. Small pilot and documentation requests are additional; coordinates, forces and energy labels are not read. Conservative family-name rules, shared configuration aliases and identical compositions define 2,050 indivisible components. A versioned weighted-factor adapter then constructs a two-fold holdout at exactly 36,920,036 training and 791,638 validation configurations. This case uses the frozen v0.1 factor implementation and a separate exact-count group assignment, rather than the primary v0.2.0.dev3 point-level solver.

On the recorded elemental-fraction vectors, the count-normalized global overlap falls from 0.969 for the original split to 0.283 after low-rank optimization. Mean nearest-training similarity falls from 0.846 to 0.194–0.196 (Table 2). The same-group feasible initialization already reduces overlap, but further optimization adds substantial separation. A dense-kernel control is competitive, so this small representative problem does not establish a low-rank speed advantage. The millions of configurations describe assignment coverage; the optimizer operates on 2,050 representatives.

Assignment	Global ratio ↓	Mean nearest ↓
Original	0.969	0.846
Groups before optimization	0.825–0.873	0.526–0.574
Low-rank optimization	0.283	0.194–0.196
Dense-kernel control	0.287	0.154–0.164

Table 2: ODAC25 composition separation at identical configuration counts. The global ratio is normalized by the random expectation at those counts. Scores use recorded elemental fractions, configuration weights, 200,000 pair draws and 512 validation queries against every distinct training formula. Ranges span three optimizer seeds, which yield only two distinct low-rank assignments. The group control uses the same exact-count feasible initialization; it is not a uniform sampler of feasible partitions.

The resulting boundary is a strong composition-shift test. Phosphorus occurs in 36.8% of validation configurations versus 1.6% of training configurations for seed zero, and two components contribute 40.6% of validation weight. Zero identical- composition overlap follows from the imposed grouping contract. These results demonstrate metadata-efficient construction of a specified holdout, while leaving its predictive and deployment relevance open. The ODAC25 section of the Supplementary Information gives the weighting, aggregation, source versions, individual seeds and numerical checks.

4 Discussion

Low-rank coordinates make dense overlap available as a split-design objective at specified fold capacities. The useful contribution is the combination of a compact objective, explicit constraints and auditable trade-offs. The matched-group controls show that optimization contributes beyond forming groups. The DataSAIL controls also show why feasible sets matter: an advantage observed at matched counts can disappear when indivisible clusters are matched as well. These comparisons support a practical computational framework without establishing universal superiority in partition quality.

Global and local overlap describe different evaluation boundaries. The plain factor favors reducing distributed similarity mass. Powers and groups can strengthen analogue separation while changing global overlap, approximation accuracy and cost. A sparse graph can provide stronger local separation for a given configuration. Choosing among these outcomes requires specifying which relationships should transfer from training to evaluation. The synthetic independent-cohort experiment demonstrates that both optimistic and pessimistic model-selection errors can result from choosing the wrong boundary.

A practical evaluation should state its intended transfer task, capacities, representation and retention policy before examining final model outcomes. It should then report global overlap, nearest-training exposure and target composition together. The software also permits fold-pair weights when only particular evaluation boundaries matter; the primary benchmarks use the ordinary all-fold objective. Label-informed changes belong to declared benchmark design or sensitivity analysis, with a separate final evaluation.

The ODAC25 application extends this design question to an atomistic corpus using a compact metadata transfer. It also illustrates the distinction between assignment coverage and independent optimization units. Its chemical shift, concentrated validation weight and competitive dense control delimit the claim: the case demonstrates a specified composition holdout, while the separate ChEMBL experiments establish measured computational scaling.

Several limits remain. The datasets are convenience samples, and conclusions about molecular separation depend on the fingerprint representation. A small returned-cut error leaves optimizer suboptimality unresolved. Powering can require substantially more rank, and strict whole-group capacities can be infeasible. Storage scaling alone does not establish fast construction at every size or tolerance. The synthetic invariant model receives the generative stable features, making it a mechanism test rather than evidence of prospective performance on real projects. Real deployment validation requires independently specified project tasks and genuine dated outcomes; simulated temporal labels cannot supply those outcomes.

5 Conclusion

Compressed fold sums support capacity-controlled similarity splitting while exposing approximation and optimization limits. Their scientific value is in constructing an evaluation boundary whose relation to the intended transfer task can be examined explicitly.

6 Methods

6.1 Implementation, data and scoring

Primary molecular experiments use the pinned v0.2.0.dev3 implementation. The ODAC25 case uses a separately frozen weighted adapter, detailed in the ODAC25 section of the Supplementary Information. AI assistance supported code development, analysis scripting and manuscript preparation. Numerical claims are checked against retained observations, source and assignment hashes, independent kernel calculations and scoped regression tests. The ODAC25 addition also retains a separate offline replay and numerical audit; its tables are generated from the verified records. The six full molecular datasets are FreeSolv, ESOL, BACE, BBBP, Lipophilicity and Tox21 [Wu et al., 2018]. Radius-two Morgan fingerprints have 1024 bits, with binary Tanimoto similarity [Rogers and Hahn, 2010, Ralaivola et al., 2005]. Structural optimization uses no response values and retains every successfully featurized input entity. Raw-input, feature, source and assignment hashes identify the exact observations. Earlier-release experiments are separated in the supplement, including the eleven-dataset molecular comparison, two composition-descriptor materials checks, neural-model reuse and external assays.

For actual counts n_c, the random expectation of the global fraction is

$$\mathbb{E}[L_S] = 1 - \frac{\sum_c n_c(n_c - 1)}{n(n-1)}. \tag{3}$$

The primary global score is $L_S/\mathbb{E}[L_S]$. The primary local score is the raw mean NNL $= |T|^{-1} \sum_{i \in T} \max_{j \in R} S_{ij}$, where T is the test fold and R the training fold. Lower values indicate less overlap. The six-dataset comparison scores all pairs and all test-to-training neighbours. Independent NumPy calculations check the saved global and local scores. Threshold ramps and alternative fingerprints are supporting diagnostics; their definitions are kept separate from the primary local score.

6.2 Controls and established comparators

The group mechanism study uses three seeds and exact 80/10/10 counts. For each dataset and seed, a single set of capped groups is fixed. A seeded capacity-feasible assignment constructed without factor values serves as the control. Ordinary and cubed factors are optimized from that incumbent while preserving every group. Exact small-instance references use twenty 12-entity binary datasets, counts 8/2/2, powers one and three, and landmark counts 2, 4, 8 and 12. Enumerating all feasible assignments measures approximation and optimization gaps separately, both without groups and with pairs as indivisible groups.

DataSAIL is the established comparator for reducing dense cross-fold similarity [Joeres et al., 2025, 2026]. An ordinary weighted k-nearest-neighbour graph tests the alternative of selecting pairs rather than compressing their similarities. We use Mt-KaHyPar's Graph API, QUALITY preset and CUT objective [Gottesbüren et al., 2024], with degrees 16, 32 and 128. Exact top-k construction, safe integer weight encoding, partitioning and any lower/upper count repair are included in its split clock. Native and repaired assignments are retained separately.

The six-dataset graph and low-rank comparison uses three split seeds, 8:1:1 proportions and tolerance 0.01. DataSAIL 1.3.0 uses C1e with SCIP on FreeSolv, ESOL, BACE and BBBP. Its prespecified grid combines cluster counts 9, $\max(9, \lfloor n/50 \rfloor)$ and $\max(9, \lfloor n/20 \rfloor)$ with solver budgets of 60 and 300 seconds, $\delta = 0.1$ and $\epsilon = 0.01$. Every native assignment receives an entity-level low-rank control at its exact counts and another control preserving the groups passed to its native solver. Equal groups do not make DataSAIL's linked cluster similarities identical to the entity-level dense objective. Solver-reported infeasibility remains a reported outcome rather than an imputed score.

Lo-Hi, UMAP/Ward, scaffold and Butina comparisons address additional retention or grouping contracts and remain in the explicitly versioned archival studies [Steshin, 2023, Hernández-Hernández and Ballester, 2023, Guo et al., 2025, Bemis and Murcko, 1996, Butina, 1999]. Their retained subsets and realized counts accompany the comparisons. They are not silently substituted for equal-constraint controls.

6.3 Fidelity, accuracy budgets and computation

Full-kernel fidelity uses six datasets, three factor seeds, five landmark counts and powers one and three. For each setting, we evaluate the current returned partition and four count-preserving perturbations against an independent full NumPy Tanimoto kernel. Absolute cut error is divided by the off-diagonal mass of the kernel at that power. This yields 900 comparisons, not 900 independent datasets.

Joint accuracy selection uses ranks 32–512, a cut tolerance of 0.05 and probe counts up to 32,768. For R rank stages and Q pair-count stages, selection checks allocate failure probability $0.025/(RQ)$ each. An independent final audit uses failure probability 0.025. A union bound gives at least 95% coverage for selection and final auditing together under the bounded-sampling assumptions. Fixed-size probe grids use the same policy with equal initial and maximum pair counts. Pair counts, allocation decisions and unestablished tolerances remain in the diagnostics. Model test outcomes do not select rank or audit budgets.

CPU comparisons use disjoint two-core affinities, two-thread native pools and hidden CUDA devices. Wall-clock split times include factorization, assignment, refinement and any method-specific graph or clustering work; feature loading, imports and quality scoring are excluded. A small common low-rank warm-up is reported separately. Native memory profiles record fresh-process peak RSS before scoring or matched controls. They include input arrays and framework overhead.

Scaling uses nested samples of packed 2048-bit ChEMBL 37 fingerprints [ChEMBL37], four restarts, two refined candidates, rank 256, and exact or 1% capacity corridors. The plain and combined settings are measured separately. Independent large-data audits use 262,144 uniform pair draws and up to 128 uniformly sampled test queries, each evaluated against the complete training fold. A conservative bounded-mean interval describes query-sampling uncertainty. End-to-end case-budget failures include loading and auditing and are distinguished from split-call timings.

6.4 Independent-cohort experiment and uncertainty

A synthetic regression generator supplies fifty observed families with forty entities each. Responses combine a linear function of four stable features, an independent family effect and observation noise. Nonnegative cosine features encode family identity and a weaker continuous signal. Two fixed models represent different inductive assumptions: five-neighbour regression on the full representation and ridge regression supplied with the generative stable features. The latter is an explicitly privileged invariant reference. Plain and combined splitting use rank 128; the plain cosine kernel uses its exact finite feature map when available.

For twenty prespecified generative seeds, each split retains 1600 training, 200 validation and 200 test entities. Models are fitted on training labels only. Their held-out RMSE and ranking are compared with independently drawn observations from families present in that training set and with observations from fifty new families. The family-reference split uses the generator's known family identities and is a mechanism control. Cohort outcomes never enter split construction. This experiment contains no real experiment dates or prospective application evidence.

Summaries average seeds within each dataset before averaging datasets. DataSAIL configuration comparisons likewise average configurations within datasets first. Descriptive bootstrap intervals resample dataset means or independent synthetic instances, using 10,000 draws and seed 31415. Seeds, models and perturbations of the same dataset are not treated as independent projects. All method settings, realized counts, native outcomes and per-case timing and memory scopes are retained.

Data and code availability

Code, manuscript sources, compiled PDFs, study manifests and saved assignments are available in the versioned PALM manuscript release. The primary numerical implementation is pinned to commit `f7e0866`; the delivered source and environment records identify later documentation and manuscript changes and reproduction adapters. Public-input recipes and checksums accompany the records. The earlier v0.1 review release preserves the archival experiments. MoleculeNet, ChEMBL, QMOF, Materials Project and SIMPD inputs retain their original attribution and terms. The ODAC25 addition, frozen adapter, compact evidence and assignment maps are included in `odac25_case` on the ODAC25 revision branch; its dataset sources retain their CC-BY-4.0 attribution. The expanded metadata caches can be regenerated from the pinned column-range requests and are not needed to rebuild the article.

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